

DP music additional guidance

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Diploma Programme

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The International Baccalaureate aims to develop inquiring, knowledgeable and caring young people who help to create a better and more peaceful world through intercultural understanding and respect.

To this end the organization works with schools, governments and international organizations to develop challenging programmes of international education and rigorous assessment.

These programmes encourage students across the world to become active, compassionate and lifelong learners who understand that other people, with their differences, can also be right.



IB learner profile

The aim of all IB programmes is to develop internationally minded people who, recognizing their common humanity and shared guardianship of the planet, help to create a better and more peaceful world.

As IB learners we strive to be:

INQUIRERS

We nurture our curiosity, developing skills for inquiry and research. We know how to learn independently and with others. We learn with enthusiasm and sustain our love of learning throughout life.

KNOWLEDGEABLE

We develop and use conceptual understanding, exploring knowledge across a range of disciplines. We engage with issues and ideas that have local and global significance.

THINKERS

We use critical and creative thinking skills to analyse and take responsible action on complex problems. We exercise initiative in making reasoned, ethical decisions.

COMMUNICATORS

We express ourselves confidently and creatively in more than one language and in many ways. We collaborate effectively, listening carefully to the perspectives of other individuals and groups.

PRINCIPLED

We act with integrity and honesty, with a strong sense of fairness and justice, and with respect for the dignity and rights of people everywhere. We take responsibility for our actions and their consequences.

OPEN-MINDED

We critically appreciate our own cultures and personal histories, as well as the values and traditions of others. We seek and evaluate a range of points of view, and we are willing to grow from the experience.

CARING

We show empathy, compassion and respect. We have a commitment to service, and we act to make a positive difference in the lives of others and in the world around us.

RISK-TAKERS

We approach uncertainty with forethought and determination; we work independently and cooperatively to explore new ideas and innovative strategies. We are resourceful and resilient in the face of challenges and change.

BALANCED

We understand the importance of balancing different aspects of our lives—intellectual, physical, and emotional—to achieve well-being for ourselves and others. We recognize our interdependence with other people and with the world in which we live.

REFLECTIVE

We thoughtfully consider the world and our own ideas and experience. We work to understand our strengths and weaknesses in order to support our learning and personal development.

The IB learner profile represents 10 attributes valued by IB World Schools. We believe these attributes, and others like them, can help individuals and groups become responsible members of local, national and global communities.

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Additional guidance on assessment

This document has been written to support teachers with additional information on assessment in DP music.

It complements the following sections of the DP *Music teacher support material*:

- Exploring music in context
- Experimenting with music
- Presenting music
- The contemporary music maker (HL only)

Exploring music in context: Additional guidance and support

The information that follows is additional guidance and support complementing the information provided for “Exploring music in context” in the “Syllabus components” section of the DP *Music guide*, as well as the submission requirements listed for “Exploring music in context” in the “External assessment” section of the guide. Please read the guide first and then the following guidance.

The exploring music component highlights students’ abilities to analyse and research diverse music and apply that musical research to their own practical music-making.

Recommended approach

Students will:

- analyse a wide range of music
- decide which pieces of music will contain the stimulus for their creating exercise and performed adaptation
- identify and extract which specific creating and performing conventions and practices (from the musical pieces/stimuli above) they will use in their practical work
- apply conventions to their own creating exercise and performed adaptation
- explain how their research findings impacted their creating exercise and performed adaptation as well as the successes and challenges in their practical work.

Possible concepts for consideration could include but not be limited to: score analysis, musical conventions, musical findings, extra-musical findings, musical extractions, implications.

Areas of inquiry

The areas of inquiry can guide students to explore music from diverse backgrounds. It is recommended that teachers explicitly support students in:

- identifying which area(s) of inquiry a piece connects with
- stating/justifying why a piece connects that/those area(s) of inquiry.

It is possible that a piece of music can fit into multiple areas of inquiry. Students should have and communicate analytical evidence for how they connect a piece of music to an area of inquiry.

Selection of repertoire

Required

This component requires students to include music from personal, local and global contexts. Additionally, the report should focus on two areas of inquiry.

Recommended

- Three or four pieces are selected for study to allow for a balanced portfolio that covers all contexts and allows for purposeful and detailed analysis within the word count.
- The student’s creating exercises and performed adaptations must be based on pieces in upload 1 (written work), enabling them to focus specifically on the implications of practical work and not a presentation of additional research for an additional piece of music.

Score and audio reference materials

Musical analysis should be supported by specific references to score and audio evidence.

Advice on uploads

- The edited material submitted in upload 3 (audio reference material) should be the only file referenced for audio material.
- Students should **not** include time stamps of original tracks. All referenced locations for audio examples should come from upload 2 (for performed adaptation and the creating exercise) and upload 3 (for analysis).

It is advised that any reference to scores or musical notation is included in the body of the report. It is not practical to reference an appendix for evidence. Students should ensure that any visual documentation of notation is extracted, annotated and labelled clearly to provide a demonstration of understanding. Bar numbers, instrumentation, clef and key should be visible.

Practical inquiry

Creating exercise

The creating exercise can be seen as a kind of musical sketch, rather than a highly sophisticated re-interpretation of the source material. The final sketch should express some of the wider musical conventions of the source material. The creating exercise should be based on pieces already referred to in the report.

Creating conventions

Careful analysis of the specific stylistic conventions of the selected musical material can help students select creating conventions and demonstrate their comprehension of the conventions through their musical creations. When analysing, students can look for accepted norms of creating music according to a chosen style, which could include musical characteristics and/or musical elements.

Performed adaptation

Recommendations

- The performed adaptation should be based on pieces explored in section 1 (exploration of a diverse musical material).
- Students are more likely to be successful if the source material is played on an instrument/voice that has significant differences from their own instrument/voice. This will encourage students to overcome certain obstacles as they negotiate aspects such as sustain, phrasing, tone colour, articulation and specific cultural performance conventions.
- The performed adaptation becomes a kind of musical problem-solving exercise that provides students with a window into performance practice.
- The main content of the written section accompanying the adaptation should outline how the student transferred performing practices from the original instrument to their chosen instrument.

Music technology considerations

- The outcome must demonstrate active use of performance aspects, such as triggering of sounds in real-time and other physical techniques controlling parameters such as dynamics, tone and rhythm.
 - As audio uploads are required for assessment purposes, a student engaging in music technology performance should detail in the report how they engaged in live performance with the technology, and this should be authenticated by the teacher in the *Music—Coursework authentication form* (6/MCAF).
- Adaptations that blur the lines between performance and composition are not likely to do well.

Experimenting with music: Additional guidance and support

The information that follows is additional guidance and support complementing the information provided for “Experimenting with music” in the “Syllabus components” section of the DP *Music guide*, as well as the submission requirements listed for “Experimenting with music” in the “Internal assessment” section of the guide. Please read the guide first and then the following clarifications.

The goal of this component is that students develop musical ideas through creating and performing, making informed choices to personalize and transform an original stimulus.

This component is all about doing something to see what happens, using critical thinking to analyse the outcome and using the analysis to inform the intentional musical choices that follow.

Recommended approach

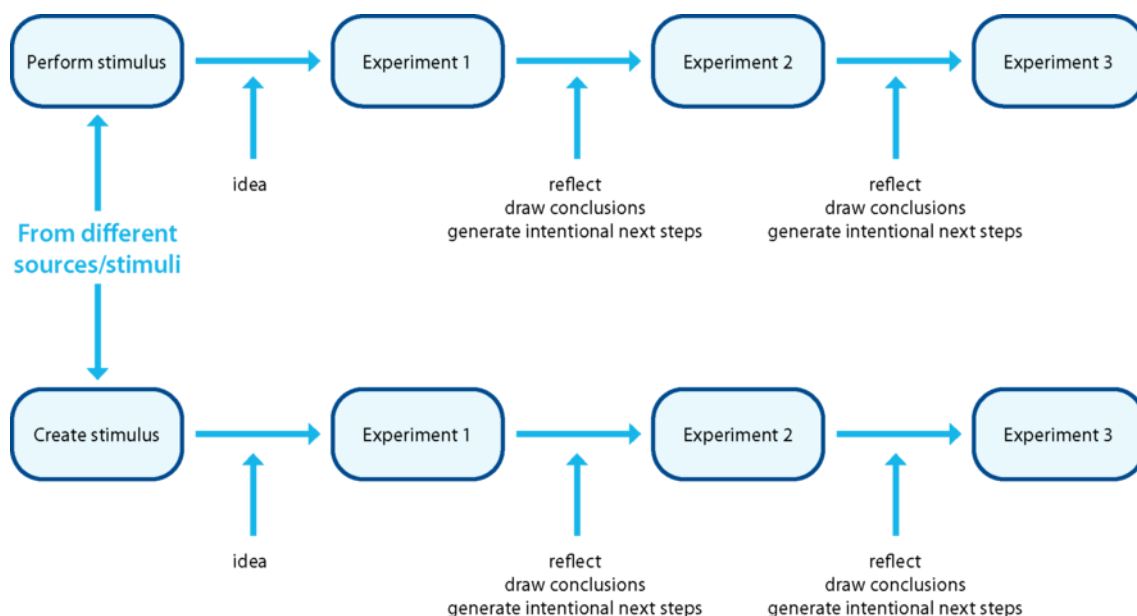
Students will:

- reflect critically and document reflections between each experiment
- ensure there is a logical progression across each series of experiments **within a role** (i.e. an experiment should lead into the next and each new experiment is an extension of the previous one):
 - performing experiments are linked together
 - creating experiments are linked together
 - performing and creating experiments should **not** be linked together (see the section below, “How the creating and performing experiments relate”).

Students who incorporate evaluative commentary and a connecting statement that explains their musical intentions for the next experiment are more likely to be successful.

How the creating and performing experiments relate

The set of three performed experiments and three created experiments evolve from different music sources, as seen in the diagram below.



It is recommended that the original musical source material (stimulus) be made clear (see “Recommendations on assessment submissions” below). Students can work with any number of sources but are encouraged to make clear which source is being developed. As the series of experimentations progresses, other sources and musical stimuli may be adopted; however, the addition of further stimuli beyond the original is not required.

All sources should be cited in the bibliography. Musical findings and decision-making in practical work should be detailed in the commentary.

Performing experiments

Performing experiments are based on experimentation with performing techniques (e.g. bowing, articulation, flutter tonguing, overblowing, pitch bending, phrasing) and (stylistic) interpretations.

In the experimentation report, it can be beneficial for students to focus on using techniques that are unfamiliar and/or innovatively used in developing their interpretation of a piece of music. Students then evaluate the techniques and interpretations in their commentary. Note that the commentary should not focus on the improvement or refinement of skills.

When writing the report, the student should only focus and comment on the performance aspects to ensure they achieve the marks available in criteria C and D. To achieve top marks in criterion D, it may be helpful for students to think about **personalizing** (i.e. bringing personal ideas and interpretations to a work or practice) their performed work through the use of different performing techniques and interpretations.

Creating experiments

In creating experiments, students begin with source material (stimulus/stimuli) and then trial creating practices to develop their experiments. Arranging, composing and improvisation are all acceptable creating processes within this component.

Improvisation can serve as a creation activity that can support the development of musical ideas.

Developing the report

In the commentary, students are encouraged to:

- describe and reference (i.e. cite) **what** source material has been used
- explain **why** this source or stimulus has been used
- explain **how** the source material has informed the experiment and the musical decision-making process.

The commentary should also explain **how** the results, findings or outcomes of this one experiment inform the progressive development of practical work for the next experiment (criteria A and C).

The use of contexts

Students will investigate unfamiliar musical source material (stimuli) from local or global contexts. The justification of local and/or global contexts is how a student explains **how** and **why** they selected their **source** material at the start and/or throughout an experimentation process.

The use of areas of inquiry

The chosen areas of inquiry encourage students to consider the purpose or function of music. Students are encouraged to identify the area of inquiry and explain how and why the purpose and/or function of the selected music influenced the student's:

- selection of a musical stimulus
- music-making process
- creative musical decision-making.

Recommendations on assessment submissions

As a reference for the examiner, it is recommended that students include a brief clip excerpt of source material they have worked with (maximum 20 seconds) at the start of the experiment. Students are encouraged to make the stimulus for transformation clear in their report.

Criteria B and D assess the treatment of source material (reiterate, recreate, adapt or transform) and this should be supported by detailed written evidence of musical findings in the commentary and audio evidence of source material.

In their writing, students must point examiners to specific places in the scores and audio files by indicating exact locations. For scores, students must indicate measures, beats, voices/instruments, etc. For audio files, students must indicate exact timings.

Additionally, students should include an appendix with scores for creating/performing as applicable.

Music technology in experimenting

Music technology is frequently employed in the experimenting process. It is recommended that students:

- specify the area of inquiry within the experiment in the commentary
- emphasize how technology has been utilized to develop the practical work
- include specific terminology related to the software and hardware used
- explain decision-making in relation to selected music technology.

An experiment that is focused on area of inquiry 3 might employ the use of technology for a purpose (for example using a digital audio workstation (DAW) to create music for film). However, the commentary will need to focus on musical decision-making related to compositional choices for the purposes of entertainment/film.

The use of music technology in performed experiments

It is recommended that the use of music technology in performed experiments demonstrates active manipulation of music technology in real time. Music technology as a performance tool should include active engagement with the technology (for example live electronic performance, DJing, computer-based performance, interactive installations, etc). Performed experiments that blur the lines between performance and composition are not likely to do well.

As audio uploads are required for assessment purposes, students engaging in music technology-focused performance experiments should detail in the report how they engaged in live performance with the technology and this should be authenticated by the teacher in the *Music—Coursework authentication form*

(6/MCAF). Students are encouraged to list the musical decisions associated with the corresponding timestamps.

Presenting music: Additional guidance and support

The information that follows is additional guidance and support complementing the information provided for “Presenting music” in the “Syllabus components” section of the DP *Music guide*, as well as the submission requirements listed for “Presenting music” in the “Internal assessment” section of the guide. Please read the guide first and then the following guidance.

Through the presenting music component, students exhibit their completed and refined performances and compositions, demonstrating the student’s musical full achievement in the course. Where other components focus on inquiry, process, experimentation or collaboration, this component puts greater significance on the final product.

Programme notes

The programme notes allow students to introduce their chosen works and justify their choices to show that they have addressed the required diversity and breadth across the four areas of inquiry in the overall programme.

It is recommended that students make the areas of inquiry a central part of the programme notes and explain how the areas of inquiry correspond with their chosen works. However, given word count limits, conciseness is necessary. Students should avoid personal points, such as personal reminiscences, and concentrate on musical facts. The most successful notes are presented in the third person present tense or past tense, and rely on musical facts and links to the area of inquiry.

Recommendations for ensemble submissions

In order for examiners to accurately and fairly assess candidates, a student’s individual part must be distinctly audible. If a student cannot be heard as an individual, their contribution to the ensemble cannot be determined and the student’s score on the assessment could be impacted. To address this challenge, it is recommended that the following points are taken into consideration.

- Small ensembles or works where the individual can be identified should be preferred over those of large-scale ensembles where individuals cannot be identified.
- Schools are encouraged to record ensemble works with a microphone set up next to the student who will be marked.
- Students submit a balance of ensemble and solo works to provide more comprehensive evidence of technical proficiency and musicianship, promoting accurate evaluation of subtleties of individual musical achievement.
 - Where it is not possible for a student to submit solo works along with their ensemble submissions, the student must submit excerpts of their individual parts from the ensemble performance. Such excerpts should be carefully chosen to align with the quality and technical demand of the ensemble submission and to fully and effectively demonstrate the full range of musical and technical capabilities of the performer.

Music technology performance/video submission

Music technology performances are to be submitted via video (upload 3). This video must demonstrate the hands and set-up of the candidate during performance, not a screen recording from a digital audio workstation (DAW) or other software.

Examples of successful submissions might include, but are not limited to:

- manipulation of sounds in real time
- use of controllers to create swells and dynamic change
- triggering sounds in a rhythmic way using devices like launchpads
- synchronization of physical movement to the beginnings and endings of bars through trigger devices creating loops in real time, such as loop pedals or Ableton-style software.

In some instances students will be using materials they have composed; in other instances they will use pre-recorded music, especially in a DJ set-up. However, it is the evidence of performance skills that are assessed, and these will be represented by coordinated physical and rhythmic manipulations by the student. The video submitted must include the hands of the candidate for accurate assessment. Students who are operating a variety of tools, devices, hardware and software at the same time are more likely to be successful.

Where students submit traditional instrumental performances along with a work that utilizes technology as part of the performance, a combination of audio for the instrumental performances and video files for the performances with technology will be submitted.

Presenting as creator

Students using music technology in their improvisations or compositions must submit their creations in upload 2 as audio evidence. Video evidence cannot be considered for evaluation within upload 2. Any visual evidence to support presenting as a creator, such as screenshots of scores and DAWs with annotations, should be included within the programme notes in upload 1.

Criterion D: Musical communication

The submissions for criterion D should include high-quality recordings and supporting evidence of musical communication.

Musical intentions

The works and their areas of inquiry as presented in the programme notes must also be represented in the recorded programme. Features that have been discussed in the programme notes should be recognizable and comprehensible in the recordings.

Notation

Notation must be submitted with all created works, and the following recommendations should be considered.

- Annotating composed works from DAW using staff/stave notation, as screenshots on their own, is limited in communicating the student's intentions and should therefore be supported by further explanatory information.
- Graphic notation that indicates where alterations of filters and other parameters have been used, as well as providing a key to explain, is helpful.
- The vital musical instrument digital interface (MIDI) elements of pitch, note-on, note-off and velocity should be shown clearly by including a screenshot of the piano roll view of the notes.
 - Most DAWs include MIDI piano roll view. Students should not use the notation view found in some DAWs, such as GarageBand, as it is often inaccurate. For more information and examples on notation, please refer to the section "Notation in the DP music course" in the TSM.

It is recommended **not** to submit a screenshot of audio waveforms, as this is not a representation of music notes, but rather of sound.

Recording quality

Quality recordings of performed works are essential to students' success. Schools are encouraged to buy recording equipment that suits their budgets and make these resources available to all students. Recordings from laptops or phones are not always sufficient.

Backing tracks

It is suggested that teachers support students in selecting appropriate accompaniments for performed pieces. Backing tracks are discouraged as they do not allow students to demonstrate a full range of musical skills. In cases where a backing track must be used, it is recommended that the backing track is played through the best possible speakers and is carefully balanced with the student to be assessed.

Editing

While the submissions will be collated from a variety of performed works, which may originate from multiple performances, the recordings for presenting as performer may not be mastered or otherwise edited.

Referencing

Students must provide references when referring to the works of others. In addition, all sources must be compiled in a bibliography and presented at the end of the programme notes (see "Upload 1: Written programme notes" in "Presenting music" in the "Internal assessment" section of the guide).

The contemporary music maker (HL only): Additional guidance and support

The information that follows is additional guidance and support complementing the information provided for “The contemporary music maker (HL only)” in the “Syllabus components” section of the DP *Music guide*, as well as the submission requirements listed for “The contemporary music maker” in the “Internal assessment” section of the guide. Please read the guide first and then the following clarifications.

In this component, students engage in collaborative, real-life musical projects as researchers, creators and performers. This component empowers students to have artistic control over a project of their own design that is rooted in their own personal context and musical identity. Students can come to realize their musical goals through the management tasks and collaboration inherent in the projects they design.

Roles

Research is an inherent skill that will be employed throughout the project. The roles of creator and performer are at the discretion of the student and should be reflective of the musical aims of the project. It is not necessary to engage in all three roles, but the student must identify what their primary practical musical role is.

The development stage involves students as creators and/or performers in the process of developing the project. It is natural that as musical leaders of the project other roles will be fulfilled including managerial/directorial roles. The commentary and process evidence can include this work; however, students should primarily focus on the musical development of the project and the collaborative decision-making process (see “Documenting the process” for “The contemporary music maker (HL only)” in the “Assessment” section of the DP *Music teacher support material*).

Note: the identified musical role of the student is the one that will be assessed in criterion C (technical and musical proficiency in the identified role). While a student may fulfil a variety of roles within the scope of project execution, it is necessary to identify one role that will inform the assessment of technical and musical proficiency.

Musical intention

As outlined in the DP *Music guide*, “Students ... must be guided by their own artistic intentions and by a distinct area of responsibility for which they take the lead” (see “The contemporary music maker (HL only)” in the “Syllabus components” section of the guide).

Students can establish specific musical goals for their project by taking into account their intended audience and incorporating insights gained from their research. Musical intentions include the role of the student leader, the roles and nature of collaboration with peers as well as the intended outcome and audience.

Process documentation

When students present evidence in the process portion of the multi-media presentation, it is recommended that they include the following:

- clear reference to the stages of the development of the music
- reflective commentary regarding the challenges and successes of the project
- strategies used for improvement
- in-depth analysis of musical and collaborative decision-making supported by specific evidence

- precise references to the musical score, workstation visuals and audio timestamp.

In the process portion of the multimedia presentation, it is recommended that students:

- include a continuous narration in the form of a voice-over or subtitles
- speak slowly and articulate clearly to aid an examiner's ability to understand the student's thinking
- carefully align visuals with narrated and/or subtitled commentary
- include visuals and text on the screen to support the commentary.

Subtitles of spoken commentary are encouraged to aid understanding, but they are not required.

Final product

Presenting the project is an essential aspect of this component and at the heart of what makes this a real-life project and a higher-level component. The final product of the contemporary music maker must be presented to the intended audience, as outlined in the project plan. "Depending on the nature of the project, the video recording of the final product is either taken during a live presentation or prepared for the live presentation of the project" (see "The final product" for "The contemporary music maker" in the "Internal assessment" section of the guide). This presentation must be included in the submission.

Clarification on uploads

Upload 1

Upload 1 should be organized as indicated in the guide (see "Upload 1" in "Submission requirements" for "The contemporary music maker" in the "Internal assessment" section): process evidence followed by product.

Part 1: Process evidence

In upload 1, students are encouraged to focus on documenting the process of how their project developed. Students can summarize their musical intentions and clearly identify their musical leadership role through a brief introduction and synthesis of the project. The majority of the process should evidence the descriptors and behaviours indicated in criterion B.

The organization of evidence is at the discretion of the student and could be presented in multiple ways, for example organized chronologically or around each descriptor (see the "Assessment criteria" (criterion B) for "The contemporary music maker" in the "Internal assessment" section of the guide).

Part 2: Final product

The final project may be curated if needed and must not exceed 7 minutes out of the total 15 minutes submitted for upload 1. The student will only be assessed on the material presented in the video; students will be assessed on the identified musical role and be awarded a mark for criterion C based on the final product evidence alone. For more guidelines for the final product, see "The final product" for "The contemporary music maker" in the "Internal assessment" section of the guide.

Upload 2

Supporting documents submitted in upload 2 provide an opportunity for more comprehensive reference to the project plan as well as full scores referenced in the multimedia presentation. It is recommended that the detailed project plan is the primary document that informs the examiner of the key aspects of the project. The suggested format is a helpful guide in constructing the plan (see "Project plan" for "The contemporary music maker" in the "Internal assessment" section of the guide). It may be helpful for students to introduce the plan with a paragraph, synthesizing the key concepts of the project: developing an artistic vision, planning and managing the project, and the nature and scope of the collaboration (see "The contemporary music maker" in the "Internal assessment" section of the guide for more information about these concepts).

Sources included in upload 2 must include all primary and secondary sources. If a student has arranged material, their individual contributions towards the arrangement need to be clear. Students should submit

original material as a cited source, as well as an uploaded score, in order for examiners to best be able to assess the student's own working and skills.

Academic integrity

Students must cite all sources, primary and secondary, and include a full bibliography in upload 2.

Multimedia presentation—videography and collaborators

In the process of documenting the contemporary music maker project process, collaborators will necessarily be present in video/audio evidence; this is acceptable for the nature of the assessment submission. Faces do not need to be blurred or edited out of the video, as the submission is for academic purposes only. To support the assessment process, HL students need to identify themselves within any video evidence.

Collaborators

Collaborators must be of school age. Students within secondary school or younger students are acceptable as well as other school-age students from other schools. It is not acceptable to collaborate with graduates, college students, professionals or teachers.

Since collaboration is such an integral aspect of this component, students should ensure that collaborators are involved in the development process and that they can document the musical outcomes of collaborative interactions. Responding to a stimulus or object developed independently (such as a painting or piece of choreography) without interpersonal exchanges and development is not acceptable to achieve full marks for evaluating collaborative choices (criterion B: Discussion of the process).